

Ai-li Baird

San Francisco Bay Area, CA

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EDUCATION

Northwestern University | Evanston, Illinois

June 2027

Bachelor of Arts in **Biological Sciences** | Minor in **Biotechnology & Biochemical Engineering** | Certificate in **Design Innovation**

Cumulative GPA: **3.91 / 4.00**

Relevant Coursework: Biostatistics, Multivariable Calculus, Designing with AI, Molecular & Cellular Biology, Genetics, Organic Chemistry

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Genentech | Hillsboro, OR

June 2026 – Sept 2026

Cell Therapy Process Engineering Intern (Incoming)

- Will optimize manufacturing scale-up initiatives for novel cell therapy programs to improve production efficiency and scalability.

Northwestern Center for Synthetic Biology, [Tullman-Ercek Lab](#) | Evanston, IL

Sept 2024 — Present

Undergraduate Researcher

- Design and engineer 10+ novel protein variants to evaluate for cancer therapeutics, generating insights to determine which lead candidates to prioritize.
- Present data-backed recommendations to cross-disciplinary stakeholders at research symposiums and weekly lab meetings, informing project strategy and future research priorities.
- Analyze experimental results, evaluating performance to troubleshoot and optimize experimental workflows.

Acurex Biosciences (Start-up) | San Carlos, CA

June 2024 — September 2024

Research & Development Intern

- Designed and conducted studies across 6+ cell types, producing evidence supporting the efficacy of the lead drug candidate that contributed to successful Series A fundraising.
- Translated experimental findings into strategic insights for cross-functional (technical R&D and business) teams, supporting executive-level decision-making.
- Delivered weekly updates synthesizing experimental results for external partner discussions to align stakeholders on company priorities.

Codapet (Start-up) | Fresno, CA

June 2023 — October 2023

Web Developer

- Optimized site SEO and designed location-specific pages for 10+ cities, boosting regional website traffic by ~40%.
- Collaborated with the development team to analyze user demographics and improve client accessibility to local veterinary services.

LEADERSHIP EXPERIENCE

Pre-Professional Technological Fraternity (Kappa Theta Pi) | Evanston, IL

September 2024 — January 2026

Vice President of Community Engagement

- Led community engagement outreach connecting 500+ members with ~30 external organizations to expand partnerships and professional development opportunities.
- Directed end-to-end recruitment for 150+ candidates, designing thorough, rubric-based interviews to improve evaluation quality.
- Synthesized and distributed career opportunities across member network, coached members in developing professional skills.
- Elected to 10-member executive board; collaborate weekly to align strategy and priorities.

Celebrasia (Asian Cultural Celebration) | Evanston, IL

January 2024 — Present

Fundraising Committee Head

- Co-executed Northwestern's largest cultural celebration, advancing campus DEI by engaging 1,000+ students through 15+ performances and 3 professional guest artists.
- Led \$1K+ fundraising campaign by managing a 20-person volunteer team to maximize outreach through on-campus initiatives.

ADDITIONAL

Gold Arrow Camp | Huntington Lake, CA

June 2025 — August 2025

Counselor & Visual Media Specialist

- Captured and edited 500+ photos daily, delivering high-quality visual content to support family engagement and social media teams.
- Mentored ~50 campers (8-13 years old), fostering leadership and teamwork through outdoor activities and reflection workshops.
- Partnered with 150+ staff and leadership teams to streamline communication and deliver a unified, high-quality camper experience.

SKILLS & INTERESTS

Technical: Microsoft Office (Excel), Google Suite, MATLAB, cell culture, NGS Sequencing, AlphaFold, protein purification, CRISPR

Languages: English (native), Mandarin (intermediate)

Interests: Triathlon, backpacking through national parks, painting, exploring the Asian food scene, guitar, sustainable fashion